RESOLUTION No. 7300

Resolution to Recognize May as Asian American Native Hawaiian and Pacific Islander Heritage Month

RECITALS

A. Asian American and Pacific Islander Heritage in the United States was celebrated beginning in 1978 and was made into a month-long event in 1992, as a way to honor and recognize the contributions of residents from Asia, India and the Pacific Islands.

B. During Asian American, Native Hawaiian, and Pacific Islander Heritage Month, we recognize the innumerable contributions, vibrant cultures, and rich heritage of Asian Americans, Native Hawaiians, and Pacific Islanders (AA and NHPIs), who have lived and worked in Oregon for more than 200 years contributing in to Oregon's and the United States' economy, culture, education, politics, arts, literature, science and technological developments despite institutional and systemic injustices designed to prevent and limit these achievements and contributions.

C. Asian American, Native Hawaiian, and Pacific Islanders are among the fastest growing communities in Oregon and Multnomah County. This migration has been both voluntary and forced due to war and environmental degradation in their native countries.

D. During Asian American, Native Hawaiian, and Pacific Islander Heritage Month we acknowledge the additional determination, hard work, and perseverance. Asian Americans, Native Hawaiians, and Pacific Islanders must put forth to be heard and seen.

E. Our schools honor and preserve the linguistic and cultural assets of students through student clubs like Asian Student Union, Asian Pacific Islander Club, Asian American Association and Vietnamese Club. Enrichment programs such as our Dual Language Immersion and the option to obtain a Seal of Biliteracy upon graduation, honor and enrich the diverse backgrounds of our heritage and native Chinese, Japanese and Vietnamese speakers, while exposing non-native speakers to diverse multilingual and multicultural perspectives.

RESOLVED

The Portland Public Schools Board of Education recognizes May as Asian American Native Hawaiian and Pacific Islander Heritage Month and strongly encourages our staff and community to observe, recognize, and celebrate the culture, heritage, and contributions of Asian American, Native Hawaiian and Pacific Islanders to our country, our state, our cities, and our schools.